David J. Henning

Most Recent Version (This Version: November 2026)

Contact Information

Room 277, Manor Road Building
Manor Road
OX1 3UQ, Oxford

Email: david.henning@economics.ox.ac.uk
Website: djhenning.github.io

Appointments

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, University of Oxford — 2025 – Present

Affiliations

Center for the Study of African Economies — 2025 – Present
Oxford Center for Macro-Experimental Development — 2025 – Present
St. Antony's College, Associate Member — 2025 – Present

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of California, Los Angeles — 2025
Advisors: Natalie Bau, Adriana Lleras-Muney, Juliana Londoño-Vélez, Manisha Shah
M.A. Economics, University of California, Los Angeles — 2021
Bsc. Economics, Politics and International Studies, University of Warwick, *2nd of graduating class* — 2017
Includes study abroad at Sciences Po, Paris

Fields

Development Economics, Public Economics

Working Papers

"Firm Networks and Tax Compliance: Experimental Evidence from Uganda" — 2026
with Miguel Almunia, Justine Knebelmann, Dorothy Nakyambadde, and Lin Tian.
Conditionally Accepted, AEJ: Economic Policy

"Family Planning, Now and Later: Infertility Fears and Africa's Stalled Contraceptive Revolution" — 2026
with Natalie Bau, Corinne Low, and Bryce Steinberg.
Revise & Resubmit, Review of Economic Studies

"Tax Audits and Their Distortionary Effects" — 2025
with Joseph Okello Ayo.

"One and Done or Repeat Inspections? The Differential Effect of Multiple Tax Audits" — 2025
with Christos Kotsogiannis, Jukka Pirtillae, and Luca Salvadori.

"Signed, Sealed, Delivered: Digital Receipts in the Ugandan Dairy Chain" — 2025
with Pedro Magaña-Saenz

Work in Progress

"Market power in developing countries" with Maria Elena Guerrero
(*analysis in progress*)

"Fast Internet as Export Promotion: Evidence from Colombia" with Nicolás de Roux and Jonas Hjort
(*analysis in progress*)

Research Grants

Total grant funding: $ 434,000; out of which as sole PI: $ 259,000

John Fell OUP Research Fund – *44,000 GBP* — 2025
Weiss Travel and Piloting Grant, with Pedro Magaña-Saenz – *15,000 USD* — 2024
Agri-SME Evidence Fund, with Pedro Magaña-Saenz – *20,000 GBP* — 2024
IGC Research Grant, with Maria Elena Guerrero – *22,000 GBP* — 2024
PEDL Exploratory Research Grant – *40,000 GBP* — 2024
Weiss Travel and Piloting Grant, with Pedro Magaña-Saenz – *15,000 USD* — 2023
J-PAL DAISI Initiative, with Pedro Magaña-Saenz – *71,000 USD* — 2023
IGC Research Grant – *71,000 GBP* — 2023
CEGA Development Economics Challenge – *10,000 USD* — 2022
IGC Small Project Facility, with Pedro Magaña-Saenz – *20,000 GBP* — 2022
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STEG PhD Research Grant – *13,000 GBP* — 2021

Awards, Fellowships

CBT Doctoral Conference Best Paper, Oxford University	2025
Dissertation Year Award, UCLA	2024 – 2025
Summit fellowship in applied economics, UCLA	2024
Honorable mention for best proseminar in applied microeconomics, UCLA	2022
Norges Bank PhD Scholarship	2021 – 2025
Graduate Student Summer Research Mentorship, UCLA	2021
Department of Economics Fellowship, UCLA	2019 – 2024
Best/Outstanding Participant, Carroll Round, Georgetown University (link)	2017
Shiv Nath Price for best performance, University of Warwick	2017

Awarded to the two best students in Economics, Politics and International Studies

Presentations

Frisch Centre, International Tax Observatory, CSAE Conference, PEDL 15th Anniversary Conference, Skatteforum, Mannheim Taxation.	2026
STEG annual workshop, PacDev, IIPF, IGC EGF Uganda, CBT Doctoral Conference, WB/ODI/IFS Public Finance Conference, IGC/EGC Conference, Kiel-CEPR AEDC, Sierra Leone Policy Conference.	2025
IGC dissemination event, STEG PhD workshop, URA dissemination event.	2022

Research Experience

Research assistant to Natalie Bau, Adrien Matray, and Manisha Shah, UCLA	2021 – 2022
Research assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist and Ameet Morjaria, Uganda	2019
Research assistant to Miguel Almunia and Jonas Hjort, Uganda	2017 – 2019

Teaching Experience

Microeconomic Theory (Econ 11), UCLA	Fall 2020
Introduction to Econometrics (Econ 103), UCLA	Winter 2021

Work Experience

UNU-WIDER – *Consultant*	2022 – 2023
International Growth Center – *Consultant, Uganda*	2018 – 2019

Professional Activities

Refereeing: Journal of European Economic Association (×3), Journal of Development Economics (×2), Review of Economics and Statistics, American Economic Review, World Bank Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Public Finance Review.
Mentorship: 2022: CEGA Non-Resident Fellowship, PhD student mentor

Miscellaneous

Skills: *Advanced:* Stata, LaTeX, *Intermediate:* Python, R
Languages: *Native:* Norwegian, German *Fluent*: English